You cannot run ahead of your competitors in a race while looking behind, with your hands or legs tied, or for that matter using poor quality shoes. Creating the right ecosystem for new technology to be adopted as quickly as possible and building competitiveness are keys to making the Indian economy grow faster and better.

Overuse of Land and Water for Agriculture is Wasteful

About 140 million hectares of India's land is used for agriculture. Only about 3 million hectares of land is used for non-agricultural purposes: residential, industry and infrastructure. This 140 million hectares of land produces 15 per cent of GDP, equal to about $0.5 trillion; 3 million hectares produces 85 per cent of GDP, or $2.5 trillion. Non-agricultural use is about 200 times more productive than agricultural use. Yet, there is so much hue and cry when land is proposed to be diverted from agricultural to non-agricultural use.

India has 4 per cent of global water for 18 per cent of global population; 80 per cent of this water is used for agriculture and the balance 20 per cent for non-agricultural, industrial and residential use. Thus, 80 per cent of water produces 15 per cent of GDP, while 20 per cent produces 85 per cent. Water is used unconscionably inefficiently in agriculture. One kilo of rice consumes 2500 litre of water, sufficient for the drinking needs of ten families for a day. Yet so much is invested to harvest and divert the water for agricultural irrigation and so little to provide tapped safe water to every family in the country.

India's land and water policies have been terribly unproductive in the past seventy-five years.

Land in India has been presumed to exist only for agriculture. Some land was diverted from agriculture use for *abadi* or residential purpose. However, land records treat and classify all lands from the point of view of agriculture. All non-arable land is noted in land records in large